

Voluntary Report – Voluntary - Public Distribution

Date: May 26, 2026

Report Number: JA2026-0030

Report Name: Japan Opens Comment Period for New JAS Standards for Almond Milk and Other JAS Revisions

Country: Japan

Post: Tokyo

Report Category: Tree Nuts, Oilseeds and Products, Agricultural Situation

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Report Highlights:

Japan is accepting public comments for the newly developed Japanese Agricultural Standards (JAS) for almond milk, as well as JAS revisions for organic algae and nishikigoi carp. Japan is also accepting public comments on maintaining the current JAS for textured soy protein products, easily chewed and easily swallowed foods, and hydroponically grown agricultural products that use probioproponics technology. Comments are only accepted in Japanese and are due by June 17, 2026.

JAS:

The [Act on Japanese Agricultural Standards](#) (JAS) ([JA2019-0195](#)) provides direction for Japan's Ministry of Agriculture, Forestry and Fisheries (MAFF) to establish and regulate voluntary [JAS standards](#) for food, forestry products, and other items. Accredited Registered Certifying Bodies inspect products to ensure conformity with JAS standards. The JAS label on products assure consumers that products meet specific, established requirements.

New Proposed JAS for Almond Milk:

On May 19, 2026, MAFF proposed a new JAS for [almond milk](#) (Japanese only). The proposed JAS defines “almond milk” as:

- A milk-like beverage manufactured from almonds and water, with an almond content of 2.0 percent or more, or
- The above product with added seasonings, edible vegetable oils and fats, dietary fiber, or flavoring ingredients (excluding milk or dairy products), with an almond content of 2.0 percent or more.

The proposed JAS also specifies quality standards.

Other JAS Actions:

Simultaneously, MAFF also proposed JAS revisions for [organic algae](#) (Japanese only) and the terminologies for “[nishikigoi](#)” koi carp breeds. After expert review, MAFF decided not to revise existing JAS standards for [textured soy protein products](#), [easily chewed and easily swallowed foods](#), and [hydroponically grown agricultural products using probioponics technology](#). The JAS Act requires each standard to undergo a review every five years or less.

Textured soy protein products include soy meat (soybean-based alternative meat products with no animal-derived ingredients) and processed soy meat products (soybean-based products that may contain certain animal-based ingredients), for which MAFF developed JAS standards in 2022 ([JA2021-0149](#)). The Japanese government has set a goal to grow sales to 3 trillion yen by 2040 for food technology, which is one of 17 strategic fields promoted by the current Prime Minister Takaichi’s Administration. This includes foods using plant-based proteins such as soy meat. The Japanese government will provide support, including for product development by startups. For more information about plant-based protein, see [JA2023-0061](#).

Public Comment Submission:

MAFF is accepting public comments in Japanese only by June 17, 2026 (Japan Standard Time) by regular mail or electronically:

- *Regular mail comments to* 〒100-8950 1-2-1 Kasumigaseki, Chiyoda-ku, Tokyo
To: Ministry of Agriculture, Forestry and Fisheries, Minister's Secretariat, New Business and Food Industry Department, Food Manufacture Affairs Division, Standards and Conformity Assessment Policy Office
- *Electronic submission:* Go to [e-Gov's](#) website.
 - [Almond Milk](#) (new)
 - [Organic Algae](#) (revision)
 - [Nishikigoi \(carp\) Vocabulary](#) (revision)
 - [Textured Soy Protein Products](#) (no change)
 - [Easily Chewed and Easily Swallowed Foods](#) (no change)
 - Hydroponically Grown [Agricultural Products Using PROBIOPONICS Technology](#) (no change)

After agreeing to the conditions, click “意見入力へ” to submit comments.

Attachments:

No Attachments.